2. Digestion cannot occur at the rate at which we eat food. Stomach acts as a storage organ and releases it into the duodenum at regulated intervals.
3. Certain vitamins like B12 are absorbed in the stomach.
4. It secretes gastric juice, which contains HCl that kills bacteria and denatures protein, pepsin that digests proteins and gastric lipase that aids in the digestion of triglycerides.
5. It also secretes gastrin into blood, which aids in gastric motility (movement).

When empty, the inner mucosal layers of the stomach fold into invaginations called rugae that unfold on intake of large meals. The pylorus of the stomach leads to duodenum of the small intestine via a smooth muscle sphincter called the pyloric sphincter.

2.1.1.5 The Small Intestine

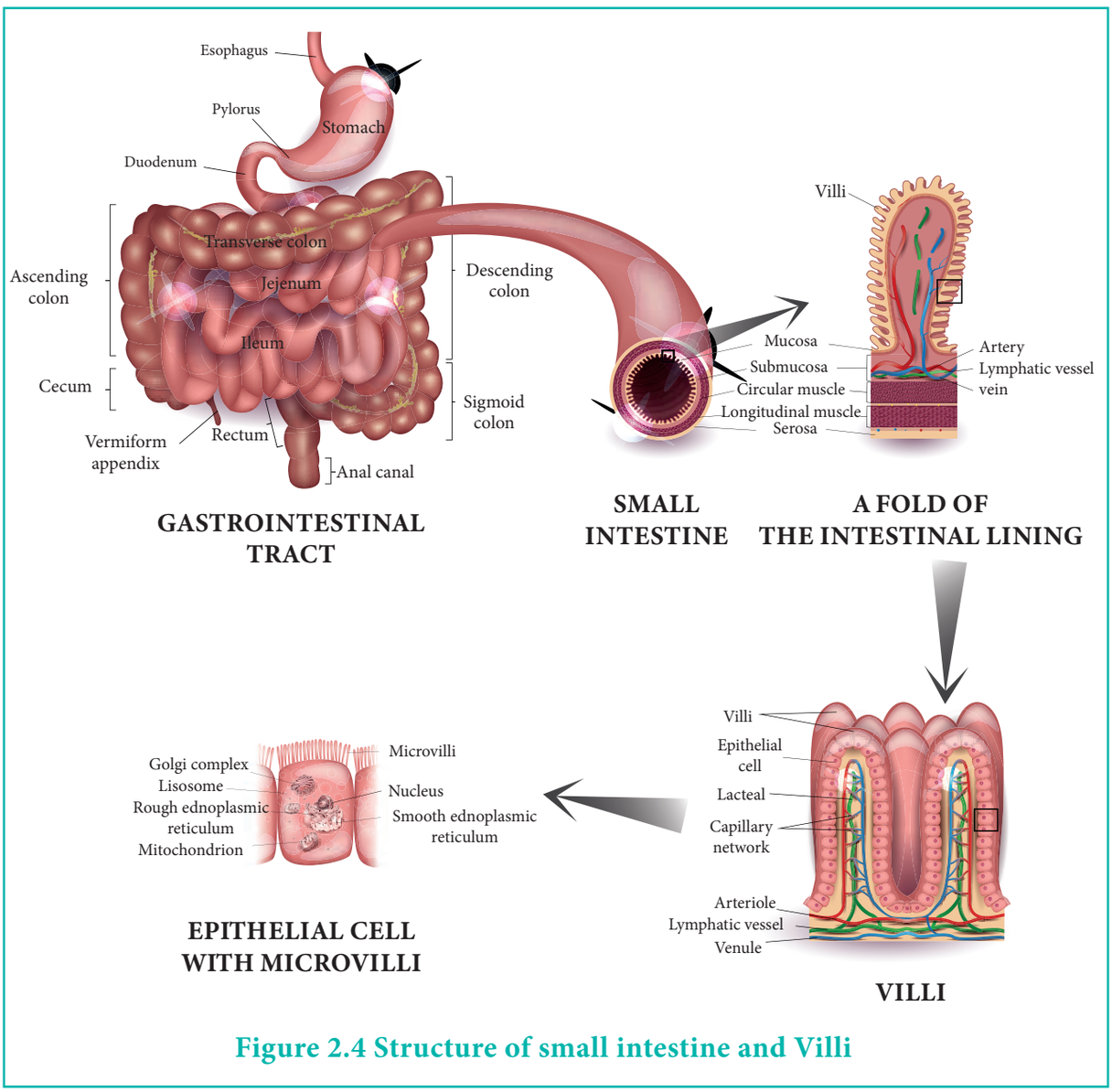


Figure 2.4 Structure of small intestine and Villi

The small intestine starts from the pyloric sphincter and opens into the large intestine. It has a diameter of about 2.5 cm and is 10 feet long in a living person. It is the region in the

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